

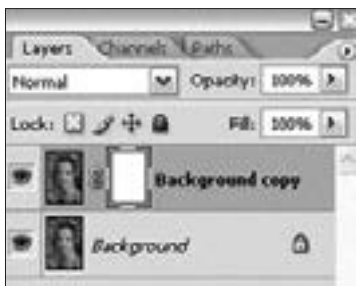
don't need to make *any* alterations to the layer you're working on, and getting back to where you started is as simple as shutting off or deleting the mask.

8.2 Getting Started With Masks

Now that we've got an idea of what masks are, it's time to see how we can create and edit them.

Creating a mask

To create a mask for a layer, click on the Create Layer Mask button () at the bottom of the Layers Palette. By default, Photoshop creates a “Reveal All” mask, which is filled with white. The name is quite suggestive—the Reveal All mask lets the layer appear as is, and it is only after you paint on black areas in the mask that the underlying layer shows through.



The Reveal All mask is filled with White

To create the exact opposite, use the “Hide All” mask, holding down [Alt] before clicking on the Create Layer Mask button. You will now see a mask that is filled with black instead of white.

Alternatively, you could go to Layer > Add Layer Mask > Reveal All or Hide All to create a new layer mask.



The Hide All mask is filled with Black